

Bacitracin



What is it?

Bacitracin is a topical antibiotic. It is in a variety of medicinal preparations used for the skin, eyes, and ears. It is used alone or with other topical antibiotics (i.e. neomycin and polymyxin B). It can be in both over the counter and prescription products.

BACITRACIN can also be known as:

- Bacitracin zinc
- Ayfivin
- Baciquent
- Fortracin
- Polysporin
- Topitracin
- Zutracin

Some Possible Uses of BACITRACIN / Where it might be found:

- Antibiotic creams and ointments, including triple antibiotic, double antibiotic
- Bandages
- Pain relief preparation
- Wound care ointment
- First aid cream
- Ear drops
- Eye drops
- Eye ointments
- Gauze
- Powders
- Scar treatments
- Ulcer preparations

Bacitracin may be combined with polymyxin B and neomycin. This is marketed as:

- Neosporin
- Triple antibiotic

Bacitracin may be combined with polymyxin B.

This is marketed as:

- Polysporin
- Double antibiotic

Other brands that can have bacitracin include:

- Corisporin ointment

What should I do to avoid BACITRACIN?

To avoid bacitracin, you will need to avoid most, if not all, antibiotic ointments that are available over the counter.

Check the complete ingredient list on the label of every product you buy for your skin, eyes, or ears.

Bacitracin may also be present in prescription products. Be sure to let your medical provider and pharmacist know about this allergy.

Bacitracin may remain in clothing even after washing. If you continue to have symptoms even after avoidance, consider discarding items you have worn on treated sites. This includes socks, gloves, bras, two-ply garments, or shoes. Such garments may keep exposing your skin to bacitracin.

OTHER:

What can you use?

Your doctor may prescribe a different treatment that is safe for you to use. If you need a topical antibiotic, some safe choices, depending on your condition, may include:

- Mupirocin (Bactroban)
- Erythromycin
- Silver sulfadiazine (Silvadene)

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Topical sulfonamides, fluoroquinolones, tetracyclines, and chloramphenicol may be safe.

Gentamicin cream or ointment is acceptable if you are not also allergic to neomycin.

You may also be instructed on how to use:

- Povidone - iodine
- Chlorhexidine
- Hydrogen peroxide
- Compresses with aluminum acetate

OTHER REACTIONS:

Bacitracin can cause hives in some people.

This type of reaction can be dangerous. If you get any of the following symptoms from contact with bacitracin, seek immediate medical attention:

- Hive-like welts
- Lip or face swelling
- Sweatiness
- Vomiting
- Shortness of breath

If this happens, absolutely avoid any future exposure to bacitracin.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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